

First-Five Outreach Targets

The fastest path to first customer is five conversations with people you already know

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The single highest-leverage thing you can do this week is contact five fintech-adjacent people from your existing network. Not strangers, not cold outbound, not LinkedIn search. Specifically people who:

- Already know you (or know someone you know who can warm-intro)
- Are currently working at a fintech / DeFi / crypto-custody / payments shop
- Have either built or are about to undergo a security audit
- Would respond to a casual ping from you within 24 hours

The exercise — 15 minutes, today

Open a fresh page. Make a table:

NAME	WHERE THEY WORK	CONNECTION	LAST CONTACT	LIKELY FIT
				bullseye / adjacent / long-tail

Fill in five rows. The bar for “fit” is low — most people in fintech adjacent roles are at least adjacent. Don’t over-think it.

Outreach — same day

Send each one a personalized message in their preferred channel (text, WhatsApp, email, LinkedIn DM, Slack, whatever). The template:

Hey <Name>,

I just shipped Preston-Check (preston-check.com) – a pre-deployment security scanner narrowed specifically to fintech compliance (PCI-DSS, MiCA, DORA, OWASP API + Smart Contract Top 10, FATF). 294 hand-curated checks. Open source.

Wondering if you'd be willing to spend 15 minutes giving me feedback on the kind of report it generates against <their stack>? No expectation that you'd buy anything – I genuinely want to know if it solves a problem you have, or if I'm building the wrong thing.

– <your handle>

Personalize the `<their stack>` reference. If they ship in TypeScript/Solidity/Java, mention that those have the deepest catalog coverage. If you don't know their stack, omit the phrase entirely.

What you're listening for

The five conversations are intentionally NOT pitches. They're diagnostic. Three signals to listen for:

1. Does the framing land? > "Yeah we use Snyk and it's noisy. Anything fintech-narrow is interesting."

→ The "fintech-narrow" thesis works. Lean into it in subsequent outreach.

2. Is there a specific pain you're solving? > "We're prepping SOC 2 right now and the evidence-package step is killing us."

→ Compliance evidence bundles are the lead feature. Position around that.

3. Would they actually pay? > "We have a budget for security tools — what's it cost?"

→ This is the buying signal. Send them the EARLY50 promo code link.

If three or more conversations produce ANY of these signals, you have product-market fit signals. If none do, the thesis needs adjustment before any further outreach.

Track outcomes — simple Google Sheet

Five columns:

Name	Date contacted	Channel	Reply?	Outcome
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| ... | ... | ... | y/n | "interested" / "not now" / "ghosted" / "bought" / "referred X" |
```

Update each row as it progresses. After all five close (any outcome), the table tells you what to do next:

PATTERN	NEXT MOVE
3+ "interested", 0 "bought"	Discovery calls — diagnose what’s blocking the close
1+ "bought"	First-customer playbook (docs/sales/playbook.md § First-customer playbook)
0 replies	Either your messaging is off, or these aren’t the right targets — try a different five
1+ "referred X"	Warm intro to X is the next outreach

Don’t skip this exercise

Most operators skip “talk to five existing contacts” and go straight to cold-emailing strangers or running paid ads. Both are 10x lower signal than a personal ping to someone who knows you. The five conversations are how you find out *whether you should be selling at all* before you spend three months selling.

If you genuinely cannot list five fintech-adjacent contacts, that’s a meta-signal — your network might not be the right place to launch this product, OR you need to spend a month at industry meetups before launching.

Time budget

- 15 minutes today: write the list
- 10 minutes today: send the five messages
- Over the next 7 days: any conversations that result, ~30 min each
- 30 minutes at end of week: tally the table, decide next steps

Total: 1–2 hours of operator time over a week, for a near-perfect calibration of whether the product solves a real problem and whether it solves it for people who buy things.